Content Strategy ??? Master Template

[CLIENT NAME] — Content Strategy

> **How to use this template.** Copy it into the client's portal: *Client Portals → [Client] → Resources → Content Overview → Content Strategy*. Replace every `[bracket]`. Delete these italic instructions before the client sees it. Keep the section order; clients learn to find things by it. Under ten pages. Vocabulary is fixed (see the box at the end); if a word isn't in the box, don't use it.

As of: [date] · **Prepared by:** [name] · **Period:** [quarter or launch window] · **Status:** Draft / Approved

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1. The plan on one page

[Client] is [one sentence that says what they are and what makes them different, in their words].

The goal for this period: [one sentence. What has to be true at the end of the period that isn't true now.]

Who we're talking to

- [Audience 1, one line]
- [Audience 2, one line]
- [Audience 3, one line]

What we're going to do about it: [three to five] pillars

Pillar	What we talk about	Share of the month
[Pillar 1]	[one line]	[%]
[Pillar 2]	[one line]	[%]
[Pillar 3]	[one line]	[%]

How it works: every piece of content lands in one of four buckets (Awareness, Desire, Story, Choice), does one job (educate, entertain, inspire, empathize, prove, convert), and passes a guardrails checklist before it posts. The rest of this document explains each part.

Instruction: if the client reads nothing else, this page is enough. Write it last.

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2. The insight

[One paragraph. What discovery told us the content has to do. Name the gap in one sentence; if you can't, discovery isn't finished. Then two or three bullets on what that changes about what we make.]

Examples from past strategies: "Information, not trust" (a lender whose people pause because they don't know anyone there yet). "Identity without a system" (a brand with a sharp look and no repeatable content). "All culture, little crave" (Taco Bell: social connected to culture but didn't create demand).

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3. Audiences

Audience	Who they are	What they need to believe before they act	What gets in the way
[Audience 1]	[who, where, situation]	"[one sentence in their voice]"	[the objection, the fear, the friction]
[Audience 2]			
[Audience 3]			

Instruction: up to three. The "needs to believe" column is the most useful line in the document; write it as something the person would actually say. Audiences out of scope for this period get one sentence under the table.

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4. Voice, positioning and taglines

How [Client] sounds: [three or four adjectives, then a sentence. "Like a knowledgeable neighbor, not a lender."]

Positioning in one line: [the sentence]

Language we use

Say this	Not this	Why
[approved term]	[banned term]	[reason: compliance, stigma, outcome vs mechanism]

Recurring messages. [Three to five] lines the brand repeats until people can finish the sentence. They show up as video end cards, caption closers, graphic cards and ad copy, across all pillars. *These are drafts for the client to rewrite in their words.*

1. **"[Message]"** — [what it answers]
2. **"[Message]"** — [what it answers]

3. **"[Message]"** — [what it answers]

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5. Pillars: what we talk about

Instruction: three to five. A pillar is a product, service, audience or theme tied to a business goal, and it should still be true a year from now. If it would change next quarter, it's a theme, not a pillar.

Pillar 1: [Name] ([%] of the month)

The business goal: [what this pillar is for, in revenue or outcome terms]

What it covers: [the subjects, the products, the people]

Why it's [this size]: [one or two sentences]

Pillar 2: [Name] ([%])

The business goal:

What it covers:

Why it's its own pillar:

Pillar 3: [Name] ([%])

The business goal:

What it covers:

Why it's smaller but not optional:

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6. Buckets: what the content does

Every piece, in every pillar, lands in one of four buckets. The bucket names never change from client to client; the purpose, qualities and placement do.

Bucket	Purpose for [Client]	Qualities (the filter)	Main jobs	Where it runs
Awareness	[make the brand and its hero product or people recognizable: how, for this client]	[4–5 adjectives]	[Inspire, Entertain...]	[channels]
Desire	[create want: crave for food, confidence for services, proof for contractors]	[4–5 adjectives]	[Educate, Inspire, Entertain...]	[channels]
Story	[build the world: people, craft, culture, community]	[4–5 adjectives]	[Empathize, Prove...]	[channels]
Choice	[enable the decision: menu, comparison, hours, how to book, how to reach a	[4–5 adjectives]	[Convert, Educate...]	[channels]

Bucket	Purpose for [Client]	Qualities (the filter)	Main jobs	Where it runs
	human]			

The qualities are the review question. Before a piece is approved, the reviewer asks whether it feels like its bucket's adjectives. If it doesn't, it isn't finished.

The grid: where the series live

	Awareness	Desire	Story	Choice
[Pillar 1]	[series · series]	[series · series · series]	[series · series]	[series · series]
[Pillar 2]				
[Pillar 3]				

Instruction: a series is a named, repeatable piece we can make again next month without a meeting. Two to four per pillar across video, photo and graphic. Not every cell needs filling. Write one sentence under the grid on where the weight sits and why.

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7. Media, formats and mood board

Three media types. Video carries the reach, photo makes the brand real and feeds the graphics, graphics carry the decision-stage content and ads.

Video

Format	Used for	Looks like for [Client]
Talking head	[series]	[framing, setting, tone]
Skit		
Testimonial		
Behind the scenes		
Educational series		
Story (24h)		
Video ad		

Photo

Format	Used for	Feeds
Hero / brand	[the signature shot]	[profiles, covers, ads, print]
Portrait		
Lifestyle		
Environment		
Detail		

Format	Used for	Feeds
Event / community		

Graphic

Format	Used for	Rules
Educational carousel		
Functional (menu, hours, how-to-book)		
Quote / testimonial card		
Recurring-message card		
Static ad		
Profile and cover		
Print		
Seasonal / event		

Photo library plan. [What the first shoot captures that gets reused for months; what every monthly shoot adds; who hands production the photo list.]

Seasonal sets. [The themes this year that get a graphic set, planned a quarter out. Holidays that don't matter to the brand don't get one.]

Mood board. One canonical board per client (Pinterest or Canva), sections by pillar and by media, plus seasonal. Link: [_____]

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8. Channels and cadence

Channel	Role	What runs there
[Instagram]		
[Facebook]		
[TikTok]		
[YouTube]		
[LinkedIn]		
[Email / SMS]		
[Paid]		
[In-location / print]		

Monthly mix (starting point, adjusted after the first month of results)

	[Pillar 1]	[Pillar 2]	[Pillar 3]
Share of posts	[%]	[%]	[%]

	[Pillar 1]	[Pillar 2]	[Pillar 3]
Heaviest bucket			
Video vs photo vs graphic			

Posting counts follow the contracted deliverables ([videos] / [graphics] / [posts] per month). Every month, every pillar appears, every bucket appears at least once, and no bucket is more than half the month.

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9. Guardrails: the checklist every piece passes

Instruction: compliance (regulated industries) or authenticity (culture-led brands) or both. Written as a checklist, because it's copied into every brief as the approval step. The client should edit this section themselves; these are their rules.

- [ ] [Required disclosure or license number on every piece]
- [ ] [Banned claims]
- [ ] [Banned language]
- [ ] [Approved terminology]
- [ ] [Testimonial rules]
- [ ] [Partner / co-branding rules]
- [ ] [Pressure language rule]
- [ ] [Captions: no em-dashes or en-dashes]
- [ ] [Client approver signed off: name]

When in doubt, the piece goes to [client's approver or compliance contact] before it goes anywhere else.

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10. Measurement: what we report and what would change the plan

Bucket	What we watch	What good looks like in the first 90 days
Awareness	reach, impressions, new followers, profile visits	
Desire	watch time, saves, shares, carousel completion	
Story	comments, DMs, shares	
Choice	[conversations, bookings, calls, form fills, cost per X]	

By pillar: share of posts delivered vs planned; which series are compounding. **By media:** video vs photo vs graphic engagement.

What would change the plan

- If [Desire is saved but Choice isn't converting] → [rework the path to the next step]

- If [Awareness grows outside the target area] → [tighten targeting]
- If a series underperforms two months running → retire it and replace from the idea bank
- Pillars don't change for at least two quarters. If one keeps needing to change, it was a theme.

Appendix: the idea bank

Every monthly brief pulls from here. Each idea is tagged Bucket · Job · Media: Format, and belongs to a series where one exists. Thirty to forty ideas is a healthy start. Mark ideas that need client buy-in before shooting.

Pillar 1: [Name]

Idea	Bucket	Job	Media: Format	Series

Pillar 2: [Name]

Idea	Bucket	Job	Media: Format	Series

Pillar 3: [Name]

Idea	Bucket	Job	Media: Format	Series

Reference accounts (format and tone, not scripts): [handles]

Vocabulary (fixed; do not rename)

Term	Means	Test
Pillar	What we talk about. Product, service, audience or theme tied to a goal. 6–24 months.	"Still true next year?"
Bucket	What the content does: Awareness · Desire · Story · Choice. Never renamed.	"Where in the journey?"
Job	The piece's intent: Educate · Entertain · Inspire · Empathize · Prove · Convert.	"What should the viewer feel or do?"
Series	A named, repeatable piece in one pillar × bucket cell.	"Again next month without a meeting?"
Media	Video · Photo · Graphic. Deliverables are counted by media.	"Which team makes it?"
Format	The production shape inside a media type.	"What does the editor or designer open?"
Theme	A time-bound campaign or seasonal angle. Has an end date.	"When does it end?"

Brief tag for every piece: **Pillar · Bucket · Job · Series (media: format)**

Source: Launchpad Content Framework Method (brain: Skills/Content Framework Method). Adapted from the Taco Bell Global Brand Creative Playbook 2025.